to use them, but it's not an exhaustive list. I don't cover all the helpers that come out of the box in ASP.NET Core (there are more coming with every release!), and you can easily create your own, as you'll see in chapter 32. Alternatively, you could use those published by others on NuGet or GitHub.

WebForms flashbacks

For those who used ASP.NET back in the day of WebForms, before the advent of the Model-View-Controller (MVC) pattern for web development, Tag Helpers may be triggering bad memories. Although the `asp-` prefix is somewhat reminiscent of ASP.NET Web Server control definitions, never fear; the two are completely different beasts.

Web Server controls were added directly to a page's backing C# class and had a broad scope that could modify seemingly unrelated parts of the page. Coupled with that, they had a complex life cycle that was hard to understand and debug when things weren't working. The perils of trying to work with that level of complexity haven't been forgotten, and Tag Helpers aren't the same.

Tag Helpers don't have a life cycle; they participate in the rendering of the element to which they're attached, and that's it. They can modify the HTML element they're attached to, but they can't modify anything else on your page, making them conceptually much simpler. An additional capability they bring is the ability to have multiple Tag Helpers acting on a single element—something Web Server controls couldn't easily achieve.

Overall, if you're writing Razor templates, you'll have a much more enjoyable experience if you embrace Tag Helpers as integral to its syntax. They bring a lot of benefits without obvious downsides, and your cross-platform-editor friends will thank you!

18.2 Creating forms using Tag Helpers

In this section you'll learn how to use some of the most useful Tag Helpers: Tag Helpers that work with forms. You'll learn how to use them to generate HTML markup based on properties of your `PageModel`, creating the correct `id` and `name` attributes, and setting the `value` of the element to the model property's value (among other things). This capability significantly reduces the amount of markup you need to write manually.